

MODERN ENGLISH

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

(Prescribed Texts)

Maximum Marks: 80

Time Allowed: Three Hours

Reading Time: Additional Fifteen Minutes

Instructions to Candidates

1. You are allowed an additional **fifteen minutes** for only reading the question paper.
2. You must **NOT** start writing during reading time.
3. This question paper has 5 printed pages.
4. It has **five** questions in all.
5. Answer **all** questions.
6. While answering Multiple Choice Questions in Section A, you are required to write only **ONE** option as the correct answer.
7. Internal choice has been given in the long answer questions on Drama, Prose and Poetry.
8. Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions in Section B.
9. The intended marks for questions are given in brackets [].

Instruction to Supervising Examiner

Kindly read aloud the Instructions given above to all the candidates present in the examination hall.

SECTION A – 20 MARKS

Question 1

Choose the correct options for the following questions.

- (i) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, why is Doolittle so splendidly dressed when he arrives at Mrs Higgins' house? (*Recall*) [1]
- (a) He is on his way to his wedding.
 - (b) He has been invited to lecture at a university.
 - (c) He has come to take Eliza home.
 - (d) He is going to the ambassador's reception.
- (ii) In Act IV of the play, *Pygmalion*, why does Eliza ask Higgins whether the clothes she has been given belong to her? (*Understand*) [1]
- (a) She wants to sell them to pay for a room.
 - (b) She hopes he will buy her more.
 - (c) She does not want to be accused of stealing when she leaves.
 - (d) She means to give them to Clara Eynsford Hill.

- (iii) Read the two statements from the play, *Pygmalion*, and choose the correct option from the ones given below. [1]
- Statement I:** As a joke, Higgins writes to an American millionaire that a common dustman is the most original moralist in England.
- Statement II:** Doolittle complains that he has been delivered into the hands of middle-class morality. (*Understand*)
- Statements I and II are similar.
 - Statement I and II are unrelated to each other.
 - Statement I is the result of Statement II.
 - Statement II is the result of Statement I.
- (iv) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, Eliza says that Freddy's love makes him "king enough" for her. What does she imply? (*Interpret*) [1]
- She expects Freddy to become rich one day.
 - She wishes to be treated as a queen.
 - She is mocking Freddy's helplessness.
 - She values being loved and cared for above rank and wealth.
- (v) From whose point of view is the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, told? (*Understand*) [1]
- An outside narrator who knows the thoughts of both players
 - The husband, in the first person and the present tense
 - The wife, looking back on the day
 - A neighbour who watches the game
- (vi) In the short story, *Games at Twilight*, where does Ravi hide? (*Recall*) [1]
- Under the veranda steps
 - In the branches of a tree
 - In a dark, disused shed full of old junk
 - Inside the house, behind a curtain
- (vii) In the short story, *The Father-Thing*, what happens to the father-thing when the creature is destroyed? (*Understand*) [1]
- It runs away into the night.
 - It collapses lifeless, like a puppet whose strings have been cut.
 - It turns back into Ted Walton.
 - It attacks Mrs Walton.
- (viii) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, with which of these is the tomato joined in its 'wedding'? (*Recall*) [1]
- Sugar
 - Onion
 - Cream
 - Bread

- (ix) Throughout the poem, *Urban*, the city-dweller is called only 'he'. What is the effect of this? [1]
(Analyse)
- (a) It presents a detached, representative city-dweller observed from outside.
 - (b) It shows that the poet is writing about a close friend.
 - (c) It hides the fact that the speaker is a woman.
 - (d) It suggests that the man is a famous person.
- (x) In the poem, *Refugee Blues*, what does the sight of fish swimming freely in the harbour make the speaker feel? (Understand) [1]
- (a) That the refugees could escape by sea
 - (b) That the city is a pleasant place to live
 - (c) That nature is as cruel as the officials
 - (d) That even fish have a freedom the refugees are denied

Question 2

Answer any **five** of the following subparts in 40-50 words.

- (i) In Act III of the play, *Pygmalion*, why does Higgins bring Eliza to his mother's 'at home'? [2]
(Recall)
- (ii) In Act V of the play, *Pygmalion*, what does Eliza mean when she says she wants a little kindness from Higgins? (Interpret) [2]
- (iii) In the short story, *Death by Scrabble*, what is ironic about the way the story ends? [2]
(Understand)
- (iv) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, why do the girls at school suddenly become so friendly with Isabel? (Understand) [2]
- (v) In the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*, why do you think the poet writes in such short lines? (Interpret) [2]
- (vi) In the poem, *The Black Santa*, why do you think the Santa is shaky and thin? (Interpret) [2]

SECTION B – 60 MARKS

PYGMALION: GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

Question 3

- (i) What do the Eynsford Hills reveal about themselves at Mrs Higgins' 'at home' in Act III? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Understand)
 - Mrs Eynsford Hill
 - Clara
- (ii) How does the play end? What does the ending leave unresolved? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(Interpret)
 - Higgins's errands and Eliza's reply
 - What the ending leaves open

- (iii) **(a)** Compare Higgins and Pickering in their treatment of Eliza in Acts III to V of the play. [10]
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b)** Doolittle's transformation in Act V runs parallel to Eliza's. How does Shaw use it to [10]
deepen the play's ideas about class and morality?
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

PERSPECTIVES: A COLLECTION OF SHORT STORIES

Question 4

- (i) In the short story, *The Doll's House*, how are the Kelvey sisters dressed? What does their [5]
appearance reveal?
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(*Understand*)
- Lil's and Else's clothes
 - What their appearance shows about their lives
- (ii) Why is the short story called *The Dreamer*? Is the title apt? [5]
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(*Interpret*)
- How Cyprian appears to others
 - What he actually does
- (iii) **(a)** Tony Peretti calls what has happened to Charles's family "a bad business". Is he right? [10]
Refer to three incidents in the short story, *The Father-Thing*.
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

OR

- (b)** How does Anita Desai use setting in the short story, *Games at Twilight*, to reflect the [10]
children's feelings? Refer to the afternoon heat, the garden and the shed.
Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

REFLECTIONS: A COLLECTION OF POEMS

Question 5

- (i) In the poem, *My Grandmother's House*, how does the poet contrast her past with her present [5]
life?
Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.
(*Interpret*)
- Her life in her grandmother's house
 - Her present condition

- (ii) In what ways are the refugees in the poem, *Refugee Blues*, denied their basic rights? [5]

Incorporate the following details and write your answer in one paragraph of 80 - 100 words.

(*Understand*)

- Material needs: home and shelter
- Social and legal identity

- (iii) (a) How does Pablo Neruda turn an ordinary vegetable into a subject worthy of an ode in the poem, *Ode to Tomatoes*? [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Analyse*)

OR

- (b) Why does the poet use a Black Santa in the poem, *The Black Santa*, to speak about race and representation? Comment on the title. [10]

Answer should be written in 150 - 200 words. (*Evaluate*)

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